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PERSONAL INFORMATION

Alessandro Muolo

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Date of birth 31 August 2000

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Nov 2024 – 2028 **PhD in Applied Economics**
Gran Sasso Science Institute (GSSI), L'Aquila (Italy)
Supervisors: *Prof. Paolo Veneri* and *Prof. Daria Denti*
Research fields: Polycentricity; Place-based policies; Urban and regional systems; Spatial econometrics; Spatial structures

Sep 2022 – Jul 2024 **Master's Degree in Economics (double degree Italy–Belgium)**
Sapienza University of Rome (Italy) and Université de Liège (Belgium)
Final grade: 110/110 *cum laude*; Magna cum laude

Sep 2019 – Jul 2022 **Bachelor's Degree in Economics**
Sapienza University of Rome (Italy)
Final grade: 110/110 *cum laude*
Participation in the excellence programme (additional courses in mathematics, statistics, microeconomics and macroeconomics), Mar 2021 – Jul 2022

Sep 2014 – Jul 2019 **Scientific high school diploma (Chinese language track)**
Convitto "Vittorio Emanuele II", Rome (Italy)

TEACHING ACTIVITIES

Mar – May 2026 Adjunct Professor for the course *Laboratory on Statistics for Policy Evaluation*, Sapienza University of Rome (Italy), 24h, taught in English

Nov – Dec 2023 Peer tutoring in MSc Econometrics courses, University of Liège (Belgium), 15h, taught in English, Prof. Barnabe Walheer (online)

Jun – Sep 2023 Peer tutoring in Bachelor's Degree Economics courses, Sapienza University of Rome (Italy), 75h, taught in Italian, Prof. Giuseppe Attanasi (online and in person)

RESEARCH FUNDING

2024 Recipient of the BSJ Research Grant no. 6/2024 (MEMOTEF Department, Faculty of Economics, Sapienza University of Rome), focused on Remote Sensing. Coordinator: Luca Salvati.

2024 – 2027 Participant as joint researcher in the European project SOSVITI (101182765), funded under the EU MSCA-MTA call. Coordinator and operational lead at Sapienza: Luca Salvati

PUBLISHED SCIENTIFIC PAPERS

- **Muolo, A.**, Konaxis, I., & Salvati, L. (2026). From Fragmentation to Integration? How Globalization Reshaped the Global Urban Hierarchy, 1950–2030. Journal of Regional Science.
- **Muolo, A.**, Bruno, E., Castellano, R., Salvati, L., & Punzo, G. (2026). Does Labour Market Area Affect Local Unemployment Rates? Evidence from Mono-centric and Polycentric Italies, 2006-2022. *Papers in Regional Science*, 100141.
- Konaxis, I., Maialetti, M., **Muolo, A.**, & Salvati, L. (2026). Monitoring long-term building activity as a multi-temporal indicator of urbanization in Mediterranean Europe. *Cities*, 174, 107072.
- **Muolo, A.**, Konaxis, I., & Salvati, L. (2025). Applying Zipf's law to land-use classes in a tourism-specialized metropolitan context. *Land Use Policy*, 155, 107580.
- Salvati, L., Alaimo, L. S., & **Muolo, A.** (2025). An operational classification of rural and urban areas based on Zipf's Law. *Annals of Operations Research*, 1–19.
- Vardopoulos, I., **Muolo, A.**, Konaxis, I., & Salvati, L. (2025). Dwelling size as a socio-spatial proxy. Planning-deficient urbanism, tourism-led gentrification, and macro-driven commodification in Athens. *Habitat International*, 166, 103614.
- Cudlin, P., **Muolo, A.**, Rontos, K., & Salvati, L. (2025). Von Thunen Revisited? An Econometric Analysis of Metropolitan Expansion and Land-Use Change in Greece. *Journal of Agricultural, Biological and Environmental Statistics*, 1–26.
- **Muolo, A.**, Postigliola, M., Alaimo, L. S., & Salvati, L. (2025). Zipf and the MAUP: empirical evidence of non-parametric estimates from a Mediterranean country. *Quality & Quantity*, 1–15.
- **Muolo, A.**, Zagaglia, B., Marucci, A., Escrivà Saneugenio, F., Sateriano, A., & Salvati, L. (2024). Cities' Hands Are Tied: Short-Term Economic Impacts of COVID-19 on Natural Population Growth in Metropolitan Greece. *Urban Science*, 8(2), 26.
- Salvucci, G., Scarpitta, D., Maialetti, M., Rontos, K., Bigiotti, S., Sateriano, A., & **Muolo, A.** (2024). Measuring Data Quality from Building Registers: A Case Study in Italy. *Geographies*, 4(3), 596–611.

SCIENTIFIC PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

- **Muolo, A.**; Bruno, E.; Punzo, G.; Salvati, L. From Global to Local Zipf's Law: Improving the Estimation of Spatial Hierarchies. *Spatial Economic Analysis* (submitted).
- Orlandi, V.; **Muolo, A.**; Salvati, L.; Attanasi, G. A Long-Run History of World Urbanization: Zipf's law tells you more? *Environment and Planning B* (First round review).
- **Muolo, A.**; Denti, D.; Veneri, P.; Salvati, L. Understanding the spatial structure of productivity: a hierarchical approach. *Socio-Economic Planning Sciences* (First round review, published as WP).
- Ballantini, F.; **Muolo, A.**; Buonomo, A.; Ahmed, M. A.; Salvati, L. From Left-Behind Places to Cities: The Territorial Expansion of Natural Decrease in Greece. *Spatial Demography* (First round review).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- From Destruction to Metropolitan Reorganization: The Spatial Effects of WWII Bombing in Italy (with Veneri P. and Denti D.)
- N-O-D-E: A Global Framework for Measuring Metropolitan Spatial Structures (with Veneri P. and Denti D.)
- Is There a Hidden Order in Metropolitan Landscapes? Exploring Land-Use Hierarchies in a Mediterranean City (with Salvati L.)

BOOKS

- Salvati, L. & **Muolo, A.** (2026) *Territorial Economics: Theory and Practice*. Elsevier.
- **Muolo, A.**, Konaxis, I., & Salvati, L. (2026). *Sustainable Urbanization and Local Development: Integrated Perspectives in Advanced Economies*. Springer Nature.
- **Muolo, A.** & Salvati, (2026). *Urban-Rural Labour Markets: Spatial Inequality, Efficiency, and Entrepreneurship in Advanced Economies.* Springer Nature.
- **Muolo, A.**, & Salvati, L. (2025). *Linking Sustainability to Competitiveness* (1st ed.). Routledge.

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CONFERENCES

24–26 Jun 2026 Muolo, A.; Denti D.; Veneri P. “N-O-D-E: A Global Framework for Measuring Metropolitan Spatial Structures”. Paper presented at the annual AISRE (Italian Regional Science Association) Conference, University of Florence, Italy.

15–19 Jun 2026 Muolo, A.; Denti D.; Veneri P. “N-O-D-E: A Global Framework for Measuring Metropolitan Spatial Structures”. Paper presented at the annual RSA (Regional Science Association) Conference, University of Göteborg, Sweden.

10–12 Sep 2025 Alaimo, L. S., Salvati, L., & Muolo, A. “An Operational Classification of Rural and Urban Areas based on Zipf’s Law”. Paper presented at the annual AISRE Conference, University of Pescara, Italy.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer for: *Annals of Regional Science*; *Population Health Metrics*; *Annali del Dipartimento di metodi e modelli per l’economia, il territorio e la finanza*; *Scientific Reports*.

DIGITAL SKILLS

Programming / tools: R, Python, Stata, LaTeX, QGIS, Microsoft Office (ECDL, 2013).

LANGUAGES

Mother tongue: Italian

Other languages

	UNDERSTANDING		SPEAKING		WRITING
	Listening	Reading	Spoken interaction	Spoken production	
English	C1	C1	C1	C1	C1
Chinese	B2	B2	B1	B1	B1
French	A2	B1	A2	A2	A2
Spanish	A2	B1	A2	A2	A2

OTHER EXPERIENCES

May 2026 Summer School in *Geospatial Data and Quantitative Analysis in Social Science*, SPACERAISE in collaboration with the Gran Sasso Science Institute (L’Aquila, Italy).

May 2026 Summer School in Regional Science, Italian Association of Regional Science (Salerno, Italy).

Jul 2025 Summer School in causal inference, Italian Econometric Association (Bertinoro, Italy).

Sep 2017 – Jan 2018 School semester at Shanghai “No.2 High School of East China Normal University” (Shanghai, China).

REFERENCES

Prof. Paolo Veneri (Gran Sasso Science Institute, Supervisor) — paolo.veneri@gssi.it
Prof. Daria Denti (Gran Sasso Science Institute, Supervisor) — daria.denti@gssi.it
Prof. Luca Salvati (Sapienza University of Rome) — luca.salvati@uniroma1.it

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